HOLLYHOCK · INTERNAL

End of Season Staff Survey 2025

This document is the printable version of the 2025 end of season staff survey report. It covers five sections: respondent profile, engagement and development, connectedness and empowerment, open-ended responses, and a cross-question synthesis. Theme and synthesis content is fully expanded. An appendix of custom and open-ended responses follows the main report.

TOTAL RESPONDENTS	ON CAMPUS	SEASONAL STAFF
28 ▼ 15 (2024)	82.1% ▼ 8.6% (2024)	67.9% ▼ 6.5% (2024)
2025 season	23 of 28	19 of 28

Respondent Profile

Seasons at Hollyhock

- 1 year or less (32.1%)
- 2–4 seasons (42.9%)
- 5–7 seasons (10.7%)
- 8+ seasons (14.3%)

New vs. returning staff

- Returning (67.9%)
- New (32.1%)

DATA NOTE

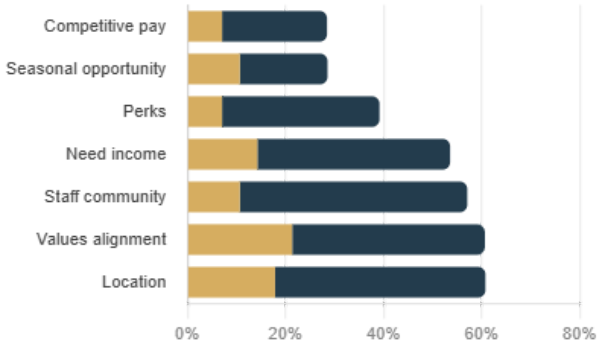
This survey reflects responses from 28 staff members. Given the small sample size, percentages and averages should be interpreted with caution. Patterns may not generalize beyond this group, and small changes in individual responses can meaningfully shift results.

Engagement & Development

Why did you join, return to, or stay at Hollyhock?

Multi-select — % of respondents; new + returning combined

New (n=9) Returning (n=19)



STAFF THEMES

Love of the place and its natural setting, sense of community and culture, and food were the most common themes in written responses.

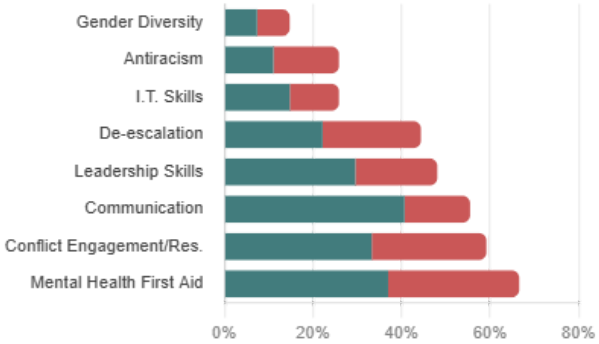
CONTEXT NOTE

New and returning staff were asked different but thematically similar versions of this question: "Why did you join?" vs. "Why have you returned or stayed?" The options were identical.

What types of training opportunities would you like to see next year?

Multi-select — % of respondents

Seasonal (n=18) Year-round (n=9)



STAFF THEMES

Specific written responses included requests for kitchen and maintenance skills training before the season begins.

CONTEXT NOTE

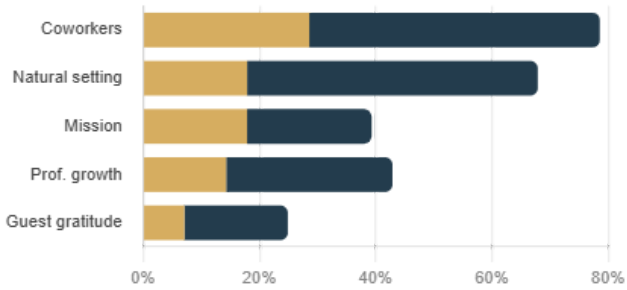
The high demand for Mental Health First Aid training is likely influenced by events that occurred during the season. This may not reflect a standing baseline level of interest.

Motivations & Challenges

Multi-select — stacked bars show each group's share of all respondents

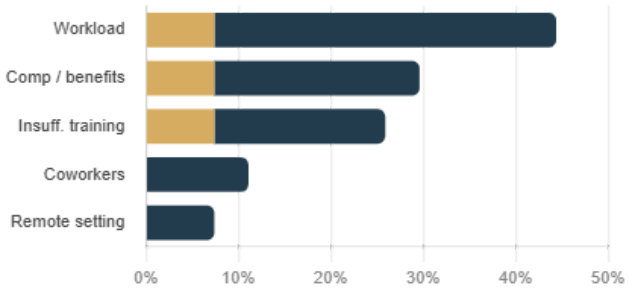
Rewarding / motivating

New (n=9) Returning (n=19)



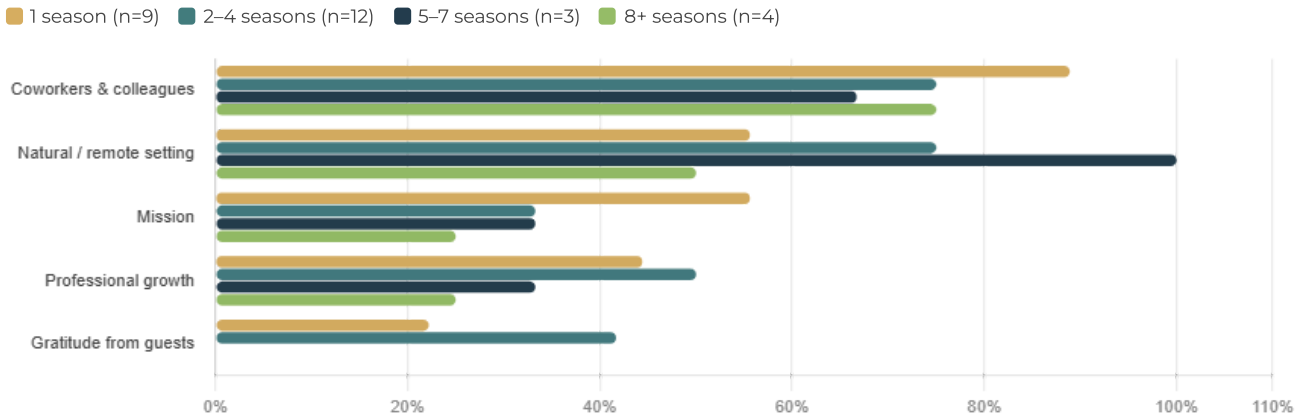
Particularly challenging

New (n=8) Returning (n=19)



What's rewarding, by tenure group?

Multi-select — % of respondents in each tenure group



REWARDING: STAFF THEMES

Written responses echoed the pre-defined options, with staff highlighting the **sense of peace and belonging** the natural setting provides. Several mentioned **pride in the team's commitment** to quality, and named the overall staff experience as a core motivating force.

CHALLENGING: STAFF THEMES

Written responses highlighted **health benefits gaps**, **communication and operational leadership** concerns, and the **physical demands** of some roles. Some staff noted concern about witnessing colleagues burn out.

KEY INSIGHTS

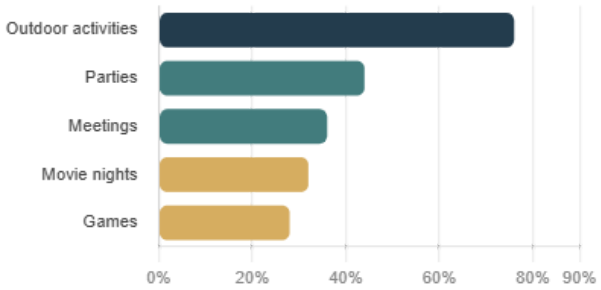
Coworkers are the primary motivator: Selected by 89% of new and 74% of returning staff, the most consistent finding across all groups and tenure lengths.

Mission resonates most with new staff and fades with tenure: 56% of first-season staff cite the leadership education mission as motivating, dropping to 25% among 8+ season staff. Long-tenured staff may benefit from active re-engagement around organizational purpose.

Workload accumulates: Only 25% of new staff flag workload as a challenge, compared to 53% of returning staff. This gap is consistent with burnout concerns in written responses and the empowerment patterns seen in the connectedness data.

Which team-building activities would you be interested in?

Multi-select — % of respondents

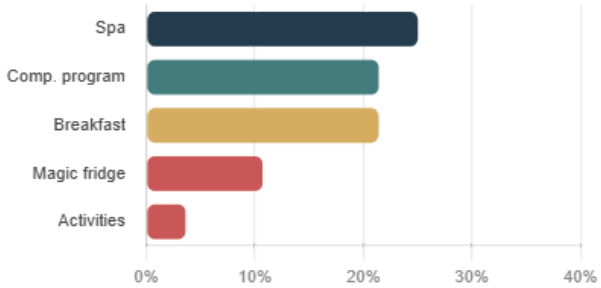


STAFF THEMES

Connection and learning were the most common themes in written responses. Staff want opportunities to share with and hear from each other, including **intimate circles and learning nights**. Remote and shift workers raised a consistent concern that **activities are often scheduled in ways that exclude them**. Both groups asked for more structured opportunities to connect with the broader team.

What is your favourite perk at Hollyhock?

Multiple choice + open response — % of respondents

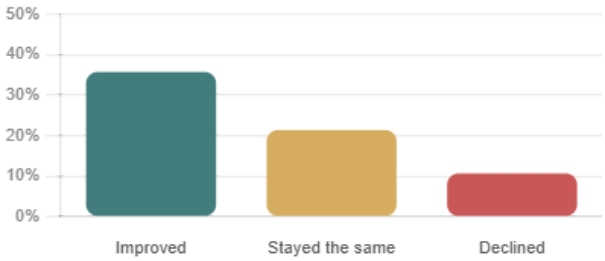


STAFF THEMES

Several staff said they couldn't choose just one perk, reflecting **broad appreciation across the board**. **Food** in particular came up repeatedly. Remote staff highlighted **accommodation access and Comp Program** as particularly meaningful. One staff member noted that **health benefits would be a welcome addition** to the package.

Has your experience of transparency at Hollyhock over the last year...

Returning staff only (n=19) — % of all respondents



Improved (n=10) Stayed the same (n=6)

Declined (n=3)

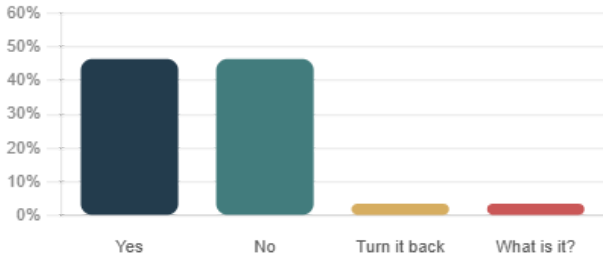
DATA NOTES

Returning staff only: This question was only asked of returning staff (n=19). New staff responses are excluded as they have no prior year to compare against.

Year-over-year comparison: In 2024, 53% of returning staff reported improvement, 31% no change, and 16% a decline, suggesting a modest softening in perceived transparency gains this year.

Did you utilize "The Burrow"?

All respondents — % of responses



Yes (n=13) No (n=13) Turn it back (n=1)

What is it? (n=1)

DATA NOTES

Single-response options: "Turn it back into a kids room" and "What is The Burrow?" each represent one respondent and should not be interpreted as trends.

Even split: Yes and No are exactly tied (13 each). With only 28 total respondents, a difference of one person would shift the result. Treat this as rough parity rather than a meaningful distinction.

Connectedness & Empowerment

CONNECTEDNESS QUESTION

On a scale of 1 to 5, how connected do you feel with your coworkers? 1 being not at all connected, 5 being very connected.

EMPOWERMENT QUESTION

On a scale from 1 to 5, how empowered do you feel to share ideas or opinions that are different from your fellow team members?

CONNECTEDNESS MEAN

3.79

out of 5

EMPOWERMENT MEAN

3.50

out of 5

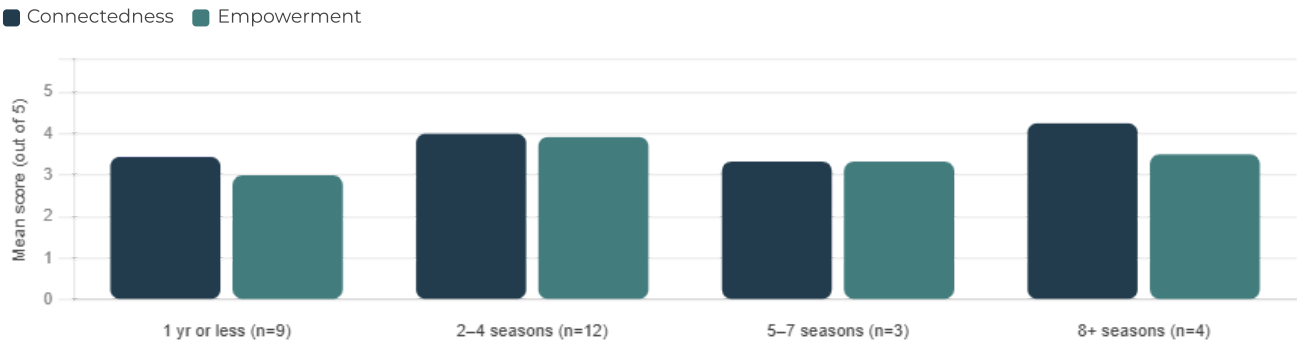
CORRELATION (R)

0.50

p = 0.007 — significant

Mean scores by tenure group

Average rating out of 5 — connectedness and empowerment compared across tenure lengths



INSIGHT

Connectedness is consistently higher than empowerment across all tenure groups. The 5–7 season group shows the widest gap (empowerment 3.33, connectedness 3.33), though this group has only 3 respondents. Staff with 8+ seasons report the highest connectedness (4.25) while newer staff report the highest empowerment mean (3.00). **Long-serving staff (8+) report the highest connectedness but their empowerment (3.50) does not keep pace**, sitting lower than the 2–4 season group (3.92).

DATA NOTE

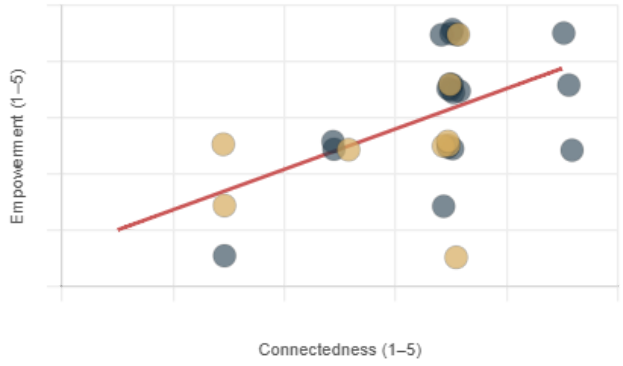
The 5–7 seasons group has only 3 respondents. Patterns in this group should not be interpreted as representative and are best treated as anecdotal.

Connectedness vs. Empowerment

Each point represents one staff member. Points are offset slightly so that overlapping responses don't hide each other.

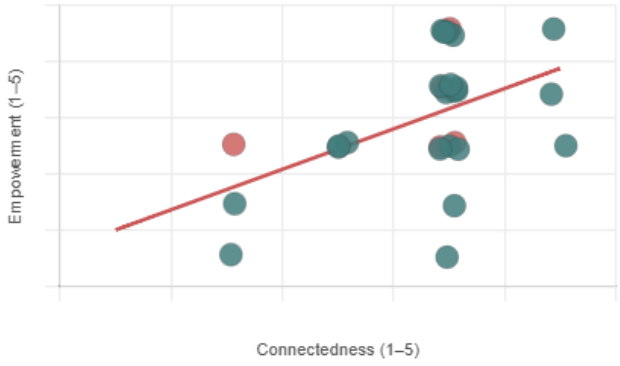
New vs. returning staff

Returning (n=19) New (n=9) Regression line



On campus vs. remote staff

On campus (n=23) Remote (n=5) Regression line



THE RELATIONSHIP

Staff who feel more socially connected also tend to feel more comfortable speaking up. Both scores sit above the midpoint, though connectedness scores higher than empowerment with less variation across staff. This gap appears to be driven more by tenure than by work location. New and returning staff show a larger spread on both measures than campus and remote staff do.

STATISTICAL SIGNIFICANCE

Even with only 28 respondents, a p-value of 0.007 indicates the relationship is unlikely to be due to chance.

PRACTICAL READ

Overall relationship: Fostering stronger team connection may help staff feel more psychologically safe to voice differing opinions. Social connection and empowerment are related, though one does not fully predict the other; other factors beyond team bonds are likely influencing how comfortable staff feel speaking up. Connectedness consistently exceeds empowerment across every subgroup examined (new, returning, campus, and remote staff alike), with the only near-exception being remote staff, where the two scores are equal (3.60).

New vs. returning staff: New staff score lower on both connectedness (3.44 vs. 3.95) and empowerment (3.00 vs. 3.74), with the empowerment gap being the larger of the two. Early integration, building social bonds and feeling established within the team, may be especially important for psychological safety.

On campus vs. remote staff: Campus and remote staff score similarly overall, but remote staff score slightly lower on connectedness (3.60 vs. 3.83) yet slightly higher on empowerment (3.60 vs. 3.48). With only 5 remote respondents this should be interpreted cautiously, but it may suggest that remote staff experience fewer in-group social dynamics that can sometimes suppress differing opinions.

Open-Ended Responses

What is something Hollyhock, as an organisation, is doing well?

Responses were notably positive and consistent. Staff pointed most often to the quality of the people and culture, the physical setting and food, and the guest programming experience. The 2025 wage increase was the most frequently cited concrete action, mentioned spontaneously across different tenures and roles. The consistency is meaningful; these are qualities that new staff recognize on arrival, without the benefit of historical comparison.

STAFF EXPERIENCE, CARE & CULTURE
14 / 28 responses — new & returning

Returning staff describe a culture that has improved meaningfully over time; new staff arrive and immediately notice the care as something distinctive.

WAGES & COMPENSATION
6 / 28 responses — mostly returning

Six respondents mentioned the 2025 wage increase without prompting. Returning staff credited it as recognition of their value; at least one new staff member also noticed the shift. No other concrete organizational action drew this level of spontaneous acknowledgment.

GUEST EXPERIENCE & PROGRAMMING
6 / 28 responses — mostly returning

Staff take pride in the quality of what Hollyhock delivers to guests. New staff echo this around team culture and the guest experience without the historical comparison returning staff bring.

FOOD & PHYSICAL SPACES
6 / 28 responses — new & returning

Food is consistently named, aligning with its rank as the top perk above. The garden, restaurant, and physical setting are framed as connective tissue for community.

DIVERSITY, LAND STEWARDSHIP & INDIGENOUS RELATIONS
3 / 28 responses — returning only

Named exclusively by returning staff, reflecting the depth of relationship that develops with place over time. These respondents frame land-based learning and indigenous partnerships as a core organizational strength.

COMMUNICATION & TRANSPARENCY EFFORTS
3 / 28 responses — new & returning

A smaller theme in this question, but notable because communication recurs as the dominant improvement area in later responses. Where it works, staff notice and appreciate it.

What is something Hollyhock as an organisation could improve on?

Responses were candid and often specific. Interestingly, new staff identified many of the same structural issues as returning staff, suggesting the concerns aren't based solely in accumulated frustration. A small number of responses raise lower-frequency but higher-stakes concerns, including conflict left unresolved, compensation inequity, and one detailed account of kitchen hygiene that warrants direct follow-up regardless of how many people raised it.

COMMUNICATION & INTERDEPARTMENTAL COORDINATION

9 / 28 responses — new & returning

The single most common improvement theme. Returning staff describe it as a systemic cost in time, money, and institutional memory. New staff arrive and notice the gaps immediately, strengthening this signal considerably.

TRAINING, ONBOARDING & PROCEDURE DOCUMENTATION

6 / 28 responses — new & returning

New staff are notably more direct about onboarding gaps; returning staff frame it as professional development. Together they identify both ends of the training pipeline. Procedure manuals are called out specifically.

STAFF CONSULTATION & COLLABORATIVE DECISION-MAKING

4 / 28 responses — returning only

All four responses came from returning staff, who have enough context to recognize when decisions are made without their input. The concern is about being consulted before, not informed after.

WORKLOAD, BURNOUT & HUSTLE CULTURE

4 / 28 responses — new & returning

Returning staff describe burnout as a structural cycle; new staff name the culture directly. The new staff framing ("hustle/urgency culture") is the explicit label for what returning staff describe in behavioral terms.

WAGES & COMPENSATION EQUITY

4 / 28 responses — new & returning

Despite Q1 praise for the wage increase, some respondents still raise wage concerns. Returning staff focus on internal equity; new staff raise absolute wage levels.

CONFLICT RESOLUTION & STAFF HOUSING

2 / 28 responses — returning only

Two returning staff raise conflict as inadequately resolved this season. Housing is named as a compounding factor, since problematic co-workers are also co-habitants.

NOTED, NOT RECURRING

24/7 STAFFING COVERAGE — NEW STAFF

"I think it would be good if there would be at least one staff member around 24/7 when guests are in, so that whatever situation occurs, there is someone in person to speak to."

INTERNSHIP & HIRING PRACTICES — RETURNING STAFF

"I've noticed a growing emphasis on adopting certain American internship practices, which seem to prioritize candidates from privileged or elite educational backgrounds. This approach can feel more like a branding exercise than one grounded in our core values. I believe the organisation could explore more inclusive and locally grounded pathways for bringing in new talent — ones that focus on genuine alignment with our mission rather than prestige."

FOOD SAFETY & KITCHEN SANITATION — RETURNING STAFF

"Please improve sanitation and cleanliness standards in the kitchen. It's beyond unsanitary, with almost all cooks fully licking the stirring/serving spoons while cooking, then right back into the pots, even when they're sick. Licking fingers or full hands and then tossing salads with said unwashed hands. Dropping things on the floor and continuing to chop them. There seems to be zero cleanliness training. Also please get sneeze guards for the buffet and some kind of cleanliness protocols in place."

What does "organizational transparency" in a workplace mean for you?

Staff across both groups converge on a shared core definition: transparency means being brought into the "why," not just the "what." Returning staff extend that definition to psychological safety and protected feedback channels, while new staff frame it more operationally, in terms of role clarity and access to organizational information. The consistency of the core definition across tenure levels makes it a reliable indicator of what staff expect from leadership.

OPEN, TIMELY COMMUNICATION ABOUT DECISIONS

12 / 24 responses — new & returning

Staff described transparency as leadership communicating clearly and openly about decisions, especially those affecting staff directly, with enough context to understand the reasoning behind them.

PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY TO SPEAK UP

5 / 24 responses — returning only

This theme was drawn entirely from returning staff. For this group, transparency extends beyond information flow to the conditions that make it safe to speak up and give feedback without fear of penalty. This connects to the empowerment gap noted in the quantitative data.

WAGE & FINANCIAL TRANSPARENCY

3 / 24 responses — new & returning

Both new and returning staff name financial and wage transparency as part of their definition. New staff frame it broadly; returning staff are more specific about SLT compensation and campus/remote wage bands.

ROLE & PROCESS CLARITY

3 / 24 responses — new staff only

This theme came entirely from new staff, who define transparency partly as knowing what their role requires and how things work. It is a more operational lens than the governance-focused definitions from returning staff.

NOTED, NOT RECURRING

CALIBRATED OPENNESS — RETURNING STAFF

"The staff are brought into the loop when it comes to change, planning, and direction. It sounds strange, but some transparency is good, too much can cause concern or be ineffective."

ORGANIZATIONAL STANDING — RETURNING STAFF

"That everyone is on the level with how the organisation is doing, what it is claiming to stand for and what it intends to become."

Signals Across the Dataset

REQUIRES FOLLOW-UP **Food safety concern**

One response contains detailed, specific allegations about kitchen hygiene practices. This is a single respondent and should not be treated as a widespread complaint. However, the specificity, urgency, and health/liability implications mean it should be investigated directly. It cannot be averaged away by its frequency in the data.

CULTURE **Burnout is structural; hustle culture is its name**

Returning staff are considerably more likely than new staff to flag workload as a concern, which may have a connection to the lack of improvement in empowerment scores with tenure. Staff describe the pattern as a seasonal burnout cycle; those newer to the organization name it directly as hustle/urgency culture and identify concrete countermeasures. Together the framings point toward a structural pattern that builds with time.

STRUCTURAL **Culture and infrastructure are out of step**

Staff consistently named Hollyhock's human dimension as its greatest strength, from the culture and care to the quality of people the organization attracts and retains. Coworkers were cited as a motivating factor by nearly 80% of respondents across all tenure levels. The most common improvement areas, however, are almost entirely structural and operational. Together they describe an organization with a strong cultural core and an infrastructure that is still catching up.

STRUCTURAL **Communication is the central organizational concern**

Communication surfaces as both a strength and a concern across the dataset. Staff praised specific communication efforts (the Hollyhock Sun, feedback channels) while simultaneously naming communication failures as the most common improvement area (9 of 28 responses). When asked what organizational transparency means to them, timely and clear communication was the most common definition. The year-over-year transparency data indicates the share of returning staff who felt transparency had improved softened between 2024 and 2025. New and returning staff converge on this issue across every section, making accumulated frustration alone unlikely to be the culprit.

STRUCTURAL **New staff name the same problems as returning staff, but faster**

New staff are not yet habituated to the organization's friction points, so their observations are fresh and unfiltered. They independently name many of the same structural concerns as returning staff (communication gaps, onboarding inadequacy, and hustle culture), despite having far less accumulated context. The empowerment data reflects a similar pattern. New staff score lower overall than returning staff, but empowerment within the returning group tends to decline with tenure. The concerns named early do not appear to resolve with time.

STRUCTURAL **Onboarding is a specific and actionable gap**

Training and onboarding was the second most commonly named improvement area, cited in 6 of 28 responses. New staff were considerably more direct about the gaps than returning staff, who tend to frame the same issue as professional development. New staff specifically named longer onboarding duration, procedure manuals by role, and better use of existing staff skills and knowledge.

STRUCTURAL **Wage progress is recognized, but equity and transparency gaps remain**

The 2025 wage increase drew spontaneous praise from six respondents, from both new and returning staff. Alongside that recognition, ongoing concerns surfaced around bodyworker pay, remote vs. campus wage bands, SLT salary visibility, and for new staff, absolute wage levels. The appreciation and the concern coexist in the same dataset.

Appendix — Survey Responses

Custom and open-ended responses only. Standard multi-select checkbox answers are reflected in the charts in the main report. Response text has been lightly cleaned for readability (spelling, encoding) but not edited for content.

CUSTOM ADDITIONS TO MULTI-SELECT QUESTIONS

These are write-in responses appended to multiple-choice questions, beyond the standard provided options.

Why did you join, return to, or stay at Hollyhock? — custom responses

1. Space away from city-living for study
2. Amazing food
3. Part of my "retirement" plan, i.e. contributing and giving back to a place I love and which has given me much in past decades.
4. I love how inviting everyone is.
5. I came for the location and fell in love with it for so many reasons. I felt cared for and appreciated.
6. Team and culture
7. Food

What types of training opportunities would you like to see next year? — custom responses

1. Anything related to maintenance
2. I will not be coming back next season, but Mental Health First Aid to those who need it would have been my first choice.
3. Kitchen Skills Training for Kitchen Staff Before Season Start
4. Expanding opportunities
5. All great options! I'm open to any and all

What's a particularly rewarding and/or motivating part of working at Hollyhock for you? — custom responses

1. Hot tub!
2. Responses from guests
3. It's one place I feel at peace in a chaotic and often angry world.
4. Working within a team that is dedicated to upholding a high standard of staff experience; working within a team that strives to offer quality work atmosphere and competitive wages for local Cortesians.

What is a particularly challenging part of working at Hollyhock for you? — custom responses

1. Lack of health benefits (health spending account only goes so far); lack of operational leadership on campus, especially as it relates to interdepartmental communication.
2. to be surrounded by so many different and always changing people all the time, but I like it though :)
3. Driving all the way from Whaletown everyday
4. Seeing colleagues burn out
5. Stressed Manager
6. Physically it would be a challenge to continue for years in the position I was in.
7. Wage inequality between local staff and remote staff.
8. High energy, different people coming every week
9. Scary spiders
10. Communication

What is your favourite perk at Hollyhock? — custom responses

1. Breakfast, and complimentary program second
2. Extra activities available for staff (e.g. yoga, presenter evenings)
3. Would be nice if the kitchen was making more food to have lunch and dinner sometimes
4. I can't pick one
5. Both breakfast and magic fridge
6. Driving down the hill on a sunny day
7. Comp program AND having a place to stay at/near campus for remote staff, without having to pay out of pocket
8. As a remote worker I really appreciate being able to come to campus for the comp program, but also to receive a discount on accommodation and meals so that I can come and visit. I also really appreciate having access to accommodation that is not taking away from paying guests.
9. All! The food probably first but having access to presenter evenings is wonderful too.
10. All of the above! But it would also be really helpful to have full health benefits!

Which team-building activities would you be interested in participating in, if offered? — custom responses

1. Intimate sharing circles, giving space to each one to speak and be heard — it can create a very deep feeling of connectedness and trust in a group, depending on how it's initiated.
2. I'd be happy to take part in any. I love the learning nights. I'd also love to see staff sharing their own skills with each other.
3. Activities that can include all staff without excluding those that are on shift when the staff activity is scheduled.
4. Professional development learnings, field trips etc.
5. More opportunities for offsite staff to connect

OPEN-ENDED QUESTION RESPONSES — ALL RESPONDENTS

What is something Hollyhock, as an organisation, is doing well?

1. Wage lift was awesome
2. Increased wages
3. Job elements are good. Laundry is done well, food is good, etc.
4. Giving a lot of trust to the guests, which creates a feeling of home
5. Deep care for employees and guests. Management really tries to uphold the mission statement of HH — the heart and soul of Hollyhock campus management is lovely. Wonderful people, spirit and intention.
6. Investing in staff experience
7. Strong work ethic and work ambiance setting
8. Generally providing guests with a positive and enriching experience.
9. Creating a positive work environment
10. Getting better at supporting onsite staff
11. Reaching out to Community and diversifying guests and staff
12. Always finding a solution fast and being caring.
13. Great food
14. Better wages, trying to pay more attention to staff experience and staff needs
15. Delivering powerful experiences for guests
16. The food has been great this year
17. Carrying for others. Offering an enriched environment.
18. Working on improving campus staff experience. There has been a positive shift in valuing campus staff with wage increases and more onsite perks. This goes a long way and translates into a higher quality guest experience. Moving in this direction will hopefully increase staff retention and seasonal return staff.
19. Communicating more (ex: The Sun) about campus operations, programming really amazing presenters, caring for the staff experience as much as the participant experience.
20. Supportive work environment where people's unique qualities are celebrated and welcome; growth opportunities for staff and guests; so many perks; staff enrichment and connection opportunities are always warm and fun; staff retention: people come back year after year because it's a great company to work for; deepening relationships with indigenous groups and the land; gratitude practices; meaningful work.
21. I think Hollyhock is doing well at trying to support a wide range of staff with a wide array of skills and needs.
22. Guest experience, team culture of helping and supporting each other
23. It promotes a safe and healthy work environment. It strives to maintain effective communication within the organization through various channels, for example "The Hollyhock Sun." It cares for employees to express their concerns and suggestions, creating opportunities to express them.
24. We have such a great staff cohort and all of the perks are wonderful. The garden and the restaurant are such beautiful connecting places. The wage raise was also greatly appreciated this year. The mission to create a vibrant and healthy community at Hollyhock that extends out into the larger world is meaningful and inspiring. The land stewardship and teachings about this specific place we live are also deeply appreciated.
25. Healthy yummy food
26. Acknowledging staff importance by raising wages.
27. Staff community
28. Hollyhock is an incredibly inclusive workplace, that puts employee welfare high on the agenda.

What is something Hollyhock as an organisation could improve on?

1. Collaborative decision making
2. When making changes I think it is essential that staff are consulted and actually listened to, no one person has all the information. Especially the staff who will have to carry out the work to implement the change or deal with the outcomes of the change.
3. Helping people understand one another. Many conflicts this year went unsatisfactorily unresolved, some were despicable.
4. I think it would be good if there would be at least one staff member around 24/7 when guests are in, so that whatever situation occurs, there is someone in person to speak to.
5. It seems like there is always budget concerns. It would take a big re-structuring, but I'm curious what could be done to support better wages for employees and also sustain the organization. The low wage was my only concern this season. Otherwise, I had a great season.
6. Long term planning
7. Communication between Supervisor/Manager/Department. General inspection of equipment and working procedures
8. Providing better support and training to staff.
9. Pay the bodyworkers reasonably
10. Wage ratio
11. Staff training in order to grow — individual, professional and as a whole
12. Better training for new staff.
13. Transparency, dealing with conflict
14. Focusing on practicality and realistic goals, listening to department needs and campus-life experience. Not hiring out of desperation, better background checks and more respectful and considerate decisions around staff housing.
15. Clarity and communication of our mission
16. Email culture
17. It could be good to find out the strengths and interests of the employees to see if they might be able to contribute in better ways. I believe most people drawn to Hollyhock are life-long learners who have much to offer.
18. Better quality and longer onboarding training. Update/creation of procedure manuals for each position. Complimentary meals while on shift or the option of a staff meal plan.
19. Summer will always be a busy season but resources can feel delicate — as soon as someone is sick or unwell, it throws off the balance. When other departments have to pick up the work, it's hard to actually use up lieu time so we get into wellness debt. Once the season is over, the burnout is SO real that the recovery time cuts into next year's planning, and cascades into already feeling "behind."
20. I feel that we could improve on interdepartmental systems and processes — and subsequently a little bit of that is communication. That said, I think we're already working on this.
21. I think Hollyhock could improve on offering professional development that can help staff grow and develop their skills and strengths.
22. Hustle/urgency culture, overwork, new processes and systems to improve workflow, reduce number of meetings, encourage staff to take lieu time, block calendars, etc.
23. There's nothing I can think of right now.
24. I've noticed a growing emphasis on adopting certain American internship practices, which seem to prioritize candidates from privileged or elite educational backgrounds. I believe the organisation could explore more inclusive and locally grounded pathways for bringing in new talent — ones that focus on genuine alignment with our mission rather than prestige.
25. Keeping bugs out of the rooms
26. For persons in leadership positions to better understand the culture that goes on in each department — the challenges they face and what key players would wish to see insofar as change. Also, more staff housing opportunities. Clear protocols need to be put into practice to assure the quick outflow of inadequate workers/roommates.

27. COMMUNICATION!!!!!!!!!!!!!!! Sooo much inefficiency, time and money wasted due to ineffective or non-communcation between depts, silo-ing or lost organizational knowledge when people leave as there's often liitle or no training manuals made before their departure.

    There's no wage transparency into SLT and upper management wages.

    Also PLEASE, PLEASE PLEASE improve sanitation and cleanliness standards in the kitchen!!! It's beyond unsanitary, with almost all cooks fully licking the stiring/serving spoons while cooking, then right back into the pots, even when they're sick. Licking fingers or full hands and then tossing salads etc with said unwashed hands. Dropping things on the floor and continuing to chop them. There seems to be zero cleanliness training! It's the worst I've ever seen! I've witnessed some horrifying things in the kitchen this year. Soooooo GROSS!!! Also PLEASE get sneeze guards for the buffett and some kind of cleanliness protocols in place! Many guests will taste things with the general serving spoons and put back into the communal dish. Some signs might help and perhaps having a fresh plate rule for getting seconds. As things are the cleanliness is incredibly bad!
28. Cross team communication could be improved. This could be by making the all-team weekly meeting a time to share big current projects and deadlines, and provide an opportunity for teams to identify areas of crossover or head off potential issues before they arise.

What does "organizational transparency" in a workplace mean for you?

1. It means that decisions are made with appropriate levels of consultation, and that people impacted are informed in a timely manner and also in an effective way so they actually receive the information that allows them to understand how their leadership operates.
2. That the roles, tasks and responsibilities are clear.
3. Openness and honesty with the management details and structure of the organization.
4. Staff understand what the organisation is doing and why and feel confident to support organisational decision making and direction in the community.
5. When something should be confidential it should stay confidential so people don't start gossiping.
6. To have senior managers and executives be completely open and honest with staff members.
7. Clear and timely communication around decisions that affect onsite staff and the campus.
8. Sharing facts rather than smooth talking.
9. Clear communication.
10. The ability to communicate openly when things are going well, but also in challenging situations — things that are unfortunately lacking, because management is operating out of fear and scarcity, and this vibration trickles down to everyone.
11. Honest and open communication, room for questions and feedback.
12. Understanding how and why decisions are made.
13. Things are open where possible.
14. Just being clear on the goals of the organization and of the roles within it.
15. Wage transparency. Equal opportunity to new and open positions both internally and publicly. Equal opportunity to perks. Managerial decisions, policy changes, budget allocations shared within the organization and accessible to all.
16. Being able to openly dialogue challenging or vulnerable topics without fear of being penalized or dismissed.
17. The staff are brought into the loop when it comes to change, planning, and direction. It sounds strange, but some transparency is good, too much can cause concern or be ineffective.
18. Organizational transparency in a workplace means that the SLT and Board are willing to communicate openly with staff about strategic plans, organizational changes, goals, intentions, and changes to process. I think it also means that there is an open channel for feedback where staff can communicate without fear of being penalized. And that their privacy around such feedback is respected and protected.
19. When an organization is open and honest about the company's goals, mission, vision, strategy, financials, challenges, etc. with all partners, including staff — and where everyone is accountable for their actions, trust is built, and communication is prioritized.
20. Openly sharing information with employees, such as decisions, processes and performance.
21. Not sure.
22. That everyone is on the level with how the organisation is doing, what it is claiming to stand for and what it intends to become.
23. SLT and upper management wage transparency for all staff. Remote and campus wage bands and how and why they differ. Transparency when making large decisions that will affect the whole organization and everyone's jobs.
24. To me, this means being open with the organization's aims, challenges, and plans.